INNOVATION POD

Readiness Checklist

PFE Assistant proof-of-concept build and validation session

Objective: ensure participants spend the event building and validating priority journeys, not resolving environments, access, data, or tooling.

Recommended delivery position

Run the event as a controlled prototype exercise using synthetic employee records, pre-provisioned identities, an approved AI endpoint, and mock integration adapters. Treat live Microsoft 365 and HR integration as a governed follow-on unless all permissions and test environments are already approved.

NOW: BUILD DAY	NEXT: GOVERNED PILOT	LATER: ENTERPRISE
Mock profiles and records Employee and manager journeys Demonstrated AI interaction	Approved authentication Volunteer user group Privacy and workflow review	Microsoft 365 and HR sources Permission-aware access Production security and support

Working assumptions

[ ] One-day event with a tightly controlled scope and a five-minute final demonstration.

[ ] Two or three user journeys only: employee appraisal, AI-assisted drafting, and manager/development visibility.

[ ] Synthetic data only; no real employee performance or personal information.

[ ] A single starter repository and reference architecture are supplied to all participants.

[ ] Production hardening, live Graph/HR integration, and broad user rollout are outside build-day scope.

1. Minimum Readiness Gate

The event should not start unless every item below is green 48 hours beforehand.

[ ] Every participant can access the repository, install dependencies, and run the starter application.

[ ] Authentication and an AI model call succeed from participant devices and the shared environment.

[ ] Synthetic data and the agreed user journeys are ready, documented, and accepted by the product owner.

[ ] A shared deployment target exists and a named technical owner can deploy to it.

[ ] Product, technical, cloud/identity, and privacy decision-makers are available during the session.

[ ] Mock integrations and deterministic AI fallback responses can keep teams moving through an outage.

[ ] The demo script, acceptance criteria, success measures, and required deliverables are agreed.

GO / NO-GO RULE: any unresolved identity, model-access, data-approval, or deployment blocker triggers a scope reduction or postponement.

2. Development Environments

[ ] Single GitHub repository with starter application, README, issue board, and simple branch/merge convention.

[ ] Runtime and package versions pinned; package lockfiles committed and dependency restore tested.

[ ] VS Code workspace settings or a dev container supplied with required extensions.

[ ] One-command setup, start, seed, test, and build scripts available.

[ ] Sample environment file contains placeholders only; no credentials are committed.

[ ] Local mock APIs cover employee profiles, accomplishments, goals, training, and manager relationships.

[ ] Shared integration environment is deployed, healthy, observable, and resettable.

[ ] Clean-machine setup is verified by someone who did not create the starter project.

[ ] Offline/mock AI mode is documented and can be enabled without code changes.

3. Access, Permissions, and Licensing

[ ] GitHub organization, repository, package registry, and pull-request access granted and tested.

[ ] GitHub Copilot Business/Enterprise seats assigned where required by the chosen workflow.

[ ] Azure subscription, resource group, spending guardrail, regional availability, and AI model quota confirmed.

[ ] Participants receive least-privilege development roles; deployment authority remains with designated leads.

[ ] Microsoft Entra test users/groups, app registration, redirect URIs, and API permissions are configured.

[ ] Azure AI endpoint access works for every team without sharing API keys.

[ ] Power Platform or Microsoft 365 developer licenses are assigned only if those services are in scope.

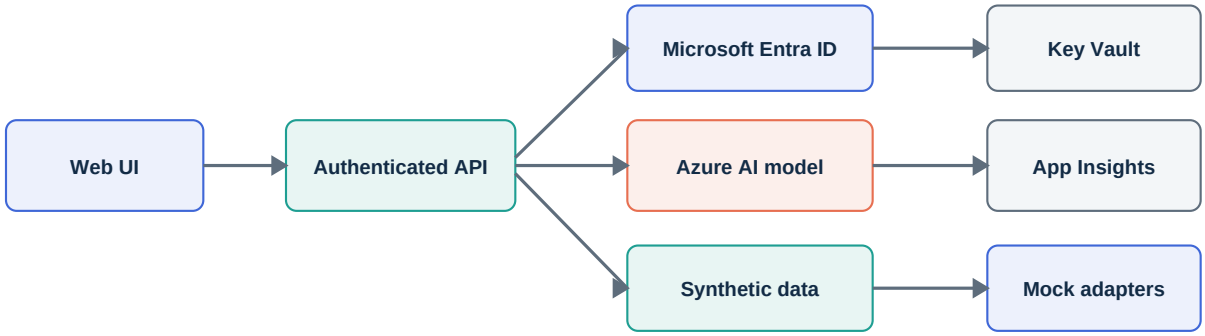
[ ] VPN, proxy, firewall, browser, package feed, and corporate device restrictions are tested in advance.

[ ] No build-day dependency remains on pending tenant-admin consent or procurement.

4. AI and Developer Tooling

- [ ] Approved model and region selected; endpoint deployed and capacity tested before the event.
- [ ] Model access occurs server-side through the approved SDK; the browser never receives model credentials.
- [ ] Prompt templates, grounding fields, expected output structure, and representative examples are supplied.
- [ ] Content-safety controls are enabled and refusal/error behavior is visible to users.
- [ ] Token limits, timeouts, retry policy, rate limits, concurrency, and event-day cost ceiling are defined.
- [ ] Application Insights or equivalent diagnostics capture latency, failures, correlation IDs, and token usage without sensitive prompt content.
- [ ] A small evaluation set covers normal, incomplete, adversarial, cross-user, and unsafe requests.
- [ ] AI output is clearly labelled and requires user confirmation before saving or submission.
- [ ] AI assists with drafting, summarization, and gap detection; it does not determine ratings, promotion, compensation, or employment outcomes.

5. Reference Architecture and Integration



Future: Microsoft 365 / HR

- [ ] Employee/manager authorization is enforced by the API and tested for cross-user access.
- [ ] Secrets and configuration are stored outside source control; managed identity is preferred for Azure access.
- [ ] Microsoft 365 and HR dependencies sit behind versioned, mockable adapter interfaces.
- [ ] Frontend/backend teams agree API contracts and sample payloads before parallel development begins.
- [ ] AI calls include correlation, timeout, retry, graceful degradation, and user-safe error states.
- [ ] Live integration remains excluded unless test tenants, permissions, sample data, and an integration owner are ready.

6. Data, Privacy, and Security

- [ ] Use synthetic records only; mark the dataset clearly as fictitious.
- [ ] Exclude real reviews, employee identifiers, compensation, health, demographic, disciplinary, and other sensitive HR information.
- [ ] Define employee, manager, administrator, and support visibility rules before implementation.
- [ ] Redact or suppress sensitive free text from prompts, logs, traces, screenshots, and telemetry.
- [ ] Define retention and deletion behavior for prompts, outputs, uploaded content, and test records.
- [ ] Test prompt injection, data exfiltration, cross-user access, harmful content, and accidental disclosure.
- [ ] Show AI provenance and require human review; provide a clear path to discard or edit generated content.
- [ ] Privacy, security, HR, and employee-relations stakeholders approve the prototype boundaries.

7. Technical Resources and SMEs

ROLE	BUILD-DAY RESPONSIBILITY	AVAILABILITY
Event lead	Own scope, agenda, decisions, timeboxes, and blocker escalation.	Full day
Product owner / HR SME	Clarify PFE workflow, policy, terminology, and acceptance criteria.	Full day
Technical lead	Own architecture, interfaces, implementation decisions, and code quality.	Full day
Azure / Entra administrator	Resolve resources, roles, identity, quota, and deployment access.	Full day or immediate on-call
AI engineer	Guide model use, prompts, safety, grounding, and evaluation.	Core build blocks
Security / privacy SME	Review data flows, threat boundaries, logging, and demo content.	Opening and review gates
UX representative	Keep employee and manager journeys coherent and testable.	Core build blocks
DevOps support	Maintain repository, pipelines, shared environment, and observability.	Full day or immediate on-call
Integration SME	Advise on Microsoft Graph, HR, learning, and enterprise constraints.	Scheduled office hours

8. Pre-Event Plan

WHEN	REQUIRED ACTIVITY	EXIT EVIDENCE
T-3 to 4 weeks	Confirm sponsor, product owner, participants, problem statement, scope, and success measures.	Approved event charter
T-2 weeks	Select journeys; agree architecture, data policy, AI boundary, and integration mocks.	Architecture and acceptance criteria
T-1 week	Provision resources, identities, licenses, model, repository, starter app, and synthetic data.	Access matrix and healthy environment
T-3 days	Run a complete clean-account dry run, including setup, AI call, tests, deployment, and demo path.	Dry-run report; blockers assigned
T-2 days	Freeze infrastructure and dependencies; execute the formal go/no-go readiness gate.	Signed readiness decision
T-1 day	Reset data, verify backup demo, publish agenda, teams, contacts, and escalation route.	Event pack distributed

Suggested build-day cadence

TIMEBOX	OUTCOME
Kickoff: 30 min	Scope, guardrails, teams, acceptance tests, and architecture confirmed.
Build block 1: 2 hr	End-to-end thin slice running with synthetic data.
Checkpoint: 20 min	Integration test, blocker triage, and scope adjustment.
Build block 2: 2.5 hr	Priority experience completed; AI and authorization tests added.
Validation: 60 min	Product, UX, safety, privacy, and technical acceptance performed.
Demo: 45 min	Five-minute demonstration, findings, recommendation, and next steps.

9. Expected Outputs and Deliverables

[ ] Working end-to-end prototype demonstrating the selected employee and manager journeys.

[ ] Five-minute live or recorded demonstration using deterministic synthetic scenarios.

[ ] Source code with setup, run, test, deployment, and troubleshooting instructions; no embedded secrets.

[ ] Current architecture, integration boundaries, data flow, and authorization model.

[ ] AI prompt set, evaluation results, observed limitations, safety findings, and example failures.

[ ] Security/privacy assumptions, unresolved decisions, and proposed mitigations.

[ ] Prioritized backlog separating governed-pilot work from production/enterprise integration.

[ ] Sponsor recommendation: proceed, revise, or stop, with owners and estimated next steps.

10. Risks, Dependencies, and Common Pitfalls

RISK / DEPENDENCY	IMPACT	PREVENTION OR FALLBACK
Access or admin-consent delay	Team cannot authenticate, call services, or deploy.	Pre-provision accounts; test each identity; keep mocks.
Model quota, throttling, or outage	AI journey becomes unreliable or unavailable.	Reserve/test quota; cap concurrency; provide deterministic responses.
Scope expansion	Multiple partial features with no demonstrable journey.	Fix two or three journeys; product owner controls backlog.
Real HR data introduced	Privacy, policy, and reputational exposure.	Synthetic-only rule; inspect seeds, prompts, logs, and demos.
AI bias or unsupported claims	Unsafe performance-management recommendations.	Restrict AI role; human review; evaluate refusal and edge cases.
Frontend/API contract mismatch	Late integration failure.	Agree contracts and fixtures; deliver a thin slice first.
Corporate network restrictions	Packages, endpoints, or authentication are blocked.	Test on participant devices and networks during dry run.
Secrets copied into code/chat	Credential exposure.	Managed identity/Key Vault; scanning; rotate immediately.
Telemetry captures personal text	Sensitive content persists outside intended stores.	Redaction, allow-listed fields, short retention, access control.
Demo instability	Session cannot show the outcome reliably.	Seed deterministic cases; rehearse; keep a recorded backup.
Prototype treated as production	Controls and integration gaps are overlooked.	Label limitations; document pilot and production exit criteria.

11. Readiness Sign-Off

Each owner should confirm readiness using evidence, not verbal assurance.

AREA	ACCOUNTABLE OWNER	STATUS	EVIDENCE / OPEN ACTION
Scope and acceptance	Product owner	Red / Amber / Green	
Starter repository	Technical lead	Red / Amber / Green	
Participant environments	DevOps lead	Red / Amber / Green	
Azure and model capacity	Cloud owner	Red / Amber / Green	
Identity and permissions	Entra administrator	Red / Amber / Green	
Synthetic data	Data owner	Red / Amber / Green	
Privacy and security	Security/privacy owner	Red / Amber / Green	
AI evaluation and safety	AI lead	Red / Amber / Green	
Shared deployment	Technical lead	Red / Amber / Green	
Demo and fallback	Event lead	Red / Amber / Green	

RECOMMENDATION: approve the event only when all minimum-gate items are green and every amber item has a named owner, workaround, and deadline.

DECISION	NAME	DATE	NOTES
Proceed / Revise / Postpone			